



Anytime Soccer Training

FOR SOCCER PARENTS

Soccer Development Scorecard

What to watch in your player's games, what to count, and how to see whether they are really getting better.

Why This Scorecard

How many times have you watched your player's team win, driven home happy, and still had a quiet feeling that nothing is really getting better? The same long balls. The same one or two players doing all the work. A win that came from being bigger or faster, not better.

And how many times has it gone the other way? The scoreboard says you lost, but you saw passes connect that never connected before. A defender who finally looked over the shoulder before the ball arrived. A team that kept the ball in its own half instead of kicking it away.

The scoreboard tells you who won the game. It doesn't tell you whether your player is developing. That is what this scorecard is for.

Neil Crawford, soccer dad and founder of Anytime Soccer Training

A STARTING POINT, NOT THE WHOLE PICTURE

There is much more to development than this simple guide covers. A player grows through things no sideline tally can capture, including:

- Technique, tactical understanding, fitness and mindset
- Confidence, and how much they enjoy the game
- The coaching, the training environment, and what they do at home

Think of this guide as a **template and a framework**. Use it as it is to start, then expand on it: add counts for your player's position, the team's game model, or whatever the coach is working on right now.

Overview

“Player development” gets said a lot in youth soccer, and it can mean almost anything. This scorecard gives it a simple, common sense meaning you can check from the sideline.

WHAT DEVELOPMENT MEANS

Development is **improved on-field performance and better decision-making**: as an individual, as a team, and as an individual within the team. It should show up in moments you can see, and to some degree count.

HOW TO USE IT

1

Pick one game. Watch your own player and the team.

2

Make a tally mark each time something on the sheet happens. Close enough is fine.

3

Do it again a few weeks later, and again a few months later. Ideally with the same team.

4

Compare the numbers. + counts should go up, – counts should come down.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- 1 If you can't count it, you can't track it.** A plan without simple numbers never turns into action or accountability.
- 2 Development means better play in games.** Better skills, understanding, mindset and fitness should show up on the field, for your player and the team.
- 3 You don't need to be a soccer expert.** Everything on this sheet can be seen from the sideline. The definitions page explains every term.
- 4 Compare your player only to themselves.** Not to teammates, and not to an age standard. The same player, game to game, over time.
- 5 Context matters.** Think about their position, the level of the opponent, and what the coach is asking them to do.
- 6 How the team scores tells you its game model.** Build-up play, counterattacks, set pieces and pressing all say something different.
- 7 Use the numbers to ask better questions, not to judge the coach.** A number going the wrong way is a reason to start a conversation.
- 8 Stay calm on the sideline.** Count quietly, don't coach from the stands, and focus on what you can control.

Game Details

	GAME 1	GAME 2	GAME 3
Date			
Opponent			
Your player's position			
Minutes played			
Final score			

Game 2 should be a few weeks after Game 1, and Game 3 a few months after. The same team makes the comparison fairest.

TEAM

WHAT TO COUNT	+/-	GAME 1	GAME 2	GAME 3
Times the team strings together 5 or more passes in a row in their own half	+			
Times the team strings together 3 or more passes in a row in the other team's half	+			
Goal-scoring chances created from 5 or more passes in a row	+			
Times the team switches the point of attack	+			
Times the team wins the ball back within 5 seconds of losing it	+			
Shots on target	+			

Your Player

WHAT TO COUNT	+/-	GAME 1	GAME 2	GAME 3
EVERY POSITION				
Touches: times they get the ball	+			
Times they lost the ball	-			
1v1s won when attacking	+			
1v1s won when defending	+			
Times they switched the point of attack	+			
Times they looked over the shoulder before receiving	+			
Times they won the ball back within 5 seconds of losing it	+			
Chances created: a pass or dribble that led to a shot	+			
Through balls played	+			
DEFENDERS ONLY				
Times they let an attacker run in behind them and get the ball	-			
GOALKEEPERS ONLY				
Saves	+			
Throws, kicks or passes that reached a teammate	+			
Throws, kicks or passes that went to the other team	-			
Times they came off their line to claim a ball or cut out a through ball	+			

Observations

Some things are better described than counted. Write a sentence or two after each game.

How does the keeper play out from the back, and does it match the team's game model?

GAME 1

GAME 2

GAME 3

Other notes

GAME 1

GAME 2

GAME 3

BETWEEN GAMES

Want to see these numbers go up?

Join Anytime Soccer Training for free with the 7-Day Soccer Skills Plan: follow-along sessions your player can do at home.

Start the Free 7-Day Plan

Key Definitions

So every parent counts the same thing.

+ and -

A + is something you want to see more of. A - is something you want to see less of.

Passes in a row

Passes between teammates without the other team touching the ball. The count starts over when the other team touches it or the ball goes out of play.

Own half / the other team's half

The two sides of the halfway line. A run of passes counts for a half when the ball stays in that half.

Goal-scoring chance

A shot, or a moment when a player is in a good position to shoot or score, even if they miss.

Switch the point of attack

Moving the ball from one side of the field to the other, with one long pass or a few quick ones, to attack where there is more space.

Win the ball back within 5 seconds

After losing the ball, getting it back within about five seconds, usually by pressing straight away.

Shot on target

A shot that would go in if the goalkeeper did not stop it.

Touches

Each time the player gets the ball. Don't count every touch while dribbling; count the times they are on the ball.

Lost the ball

The player had the ball and the other team took it or intercepted their pass. A shot that misses does not count.

1v1 won (attacking)

With the ball and one defender to beat, the player gets past them or keeps the ball.

1v1 won (defending)

Facing one attacker, the player stops them getting past or takes the ball away.

Looking over the shoulder

Turning the head to check what is around before the ball arrives. Also called scanning.

Chance created

A pass or dribble by the player that leads straight to a shot.

Through ball

A pass into the space behind the defenders for a teammate to run onto.

Run in behind

An attacker running past a defender into the space between that defender and the goal.

Save

The goalkeeper stops a shot on target.

Distribution

How the goalkeeper puts the ball back into play: throws, kicks and passes.

Coming off the line

The goalkeeper leaves the goal line to catch a cross, pick up a loose ball, or reach a through ball before an attacker.

Playing out from the back

Starting attacks with short passes from the goalkeeper and defenders instead of kicking long.

Game model

The way the team is coached to play, such as keeping the ball and building from the back, or pressing high and counterattacking. If you're not sure, ask the coach.

Keep Them Improving Between Games

The numbers on this scorecard move when players get more touches on the ball. Most of that has to happen away from team practice.

FREE FOR PARENTS AND PLAYERS

Join Anytime Soccer Training for free with the 7-Day Soccer Skills Plan

Seven follow-along video sessions your player can do at home. They press play and copy the drills.

- 7 follow-along sessions
- 10 minutes a day
- Perfect for ages 6-14
- No credit card needed

Start the Free 7-Day Plan

www.anytime-soccer.com/free-soccer-drills-for-kids